

The Jocabian Blue Little Devil

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“How can you idolize a Being who allows children to be raped?” (jocabx)

Over my many years of atheism — approximately since I was 12 years old — I have gathered many arguments against the existence of God. Some refer to the Catholic God, who has well-defined properties; others concern gods with a more nebulous definition, and therefore harder to analyze logically. In any case, in almost all instances, God always has the characteristic of being, at minimum, the creator of the universe, and almost always also possessing consciousness and intelligence.

Among the arguments of my own authorship, the most recent — and the one I consider the most ‘stunning’, for being extremely simple yet devastating — is the “Jocabian Blue Little Devil.” Below are summaries of the main anti-God arguments and proofs, beginning with the one that gives this text its title. (The names in brackets ‘[]’ beside each argument are the probable authors of the original idea, or the person through whom I came to know it.)

0 – Jocabian Proof of Divine Nonexistence [Jocab]

“If the supposed God did not know about ALL the children who would necessarily be raped before He even created the world, then that God was NOT omniscient! And therefore, an omniscient God does not exist.

If the supposed God did know, He would be RESPONSIBLE for those barbarities, because He KNEW that by creating the world as it was created, all those rapes would necessarily occur — and yet He carried out His malevolent plan. Therefore, a benevolent God does not exist.”

Therefore, a benevolent and omniscient God does not exist.

1 – Argument: “The Jocabian Blue Little Devil” [Jocab]

It is said that God is a necessary entity to answer the question: “How did the universe arise?”

If we answered with the same question “How did God arise?”, the theist would say that God needs no creator — He is the cause of Himself, or He always existed, or He is beyond our comprehension. And there is no point in counter-arguing that we could use the same arguments by simply replacing the word “God” with “Universe.” The theist mind demands a creator for the universe, whether one likes it or not. However, attached to this creator-God come all the other qualifications normally attributed to God — goodness, omniscience, omnipotence, perfection, and so forth — as a way of satisfying our psychological needs. But, recognizing that none of these qualities are strictly necessary to create a universe, the “Jocabian Blue Little Devil” argument emerges:

If you say that God created the universe, I can EQUALLY SUPPOSE that it was not God who created it, but rather the “Blue Little Devil.” Except that this little devil is not all-powerful like God, does not have God’s omniscience, is not good like God, is not perfect like God, and — in order to create the universe — he died from the sheer effort involved.

Since my little devil is much simpler and less complex than your all-powerful God, he should be PREFERABLE in terms of Occam’s Razor. Therefore, before invoking God as the creator of the universe, you should invoke the “Jocaxian Blue Little Devil.” Otherwise, you would be acting illogically by adding unnecessary hypotheses to the ‘creator of the Universe.’

Commentary: A creator with all the properties of a “God” is not necessary to create the universe — one only needs sufficient power to bring it into being. Thus, the claim that a “God” is necessary for the universe to exist lacks logical foundation.

2 – Proof: Contradiction with the FACTS [Epicurus/Hume]

If God is Good, then God does not want useless suffering.

If God is powerful, then God can do anything.

Logic: If God can do anything and does not want suffering, then He can prevent suffering.

Fact: 40,000 children recently died drowning in a tsunami (death with suffering).

Conclusion: The hypotheses (a good and powerful God) cannot be true, as they contradict the observed facts.

Commentary: Some may argue the suffering was necessary because certain people needed to “learn.” One can counter by asking what children learn from drowning. Against “original sin” one can question whether it is just for the innocent to pay for the guilty. But this is unnecessary: a good and all-powerful God could teach anything to anyone without sacrificing innocent lives in tragic deaths. If God needed to sacrifice so many lives, He is either not sufficiently powerful or not good (in the human sense of the word). The original argument appears to trace back to Epicurus, though its formal articulation is attributed to Hume.

3 – Proof: Internal Contradiction (Inconsistency) [Sartre (?)]

God is OMNISCIENT, therefore He knows everything that has happened and will happen.

God gave man free will, therefore man is free to choose.

Contradiction: If God knows everything man will choose (factual knowledge), then man does NOT have freedom of choice. (Everything was foreseen in God’s mind and man could not change it.)

Demonstration [by Jocax]:

Suppose, for argument's sake, that an All-Powerful God exists. Then it logically follows that:

1. God is Omniscient.
2. Being Omniscient, He knows EVERYTHING that will happen.
3. Knowing EVERYTHING that will happen, He knows everything you will do and choose, even before you exist.
4. If God knows everything you will do and choose, then you cannot do anything different from God's foresight.
5. If you cannot do anything different from the divine foresight, you will necessarily and obligatorily have to follow it.
6. If you are obliged to follow God's foresight, then it is impossible for you to choose or do anything other than what was divinely foreseen.
7. If it is impossible for you to choose or do anything different from the divine foresight, you have no free will! Q.E.D.

Commentary: Even before a man is born, before he marries or makes any kind of choices, his destiny would already be foreseen in God's omniscient mind. Therefore, nothing the man chose would differ from the path already foreseen by God. As such, so-called "Free Will" would be nothing but an illusion. This means: either man is not free to choose, or God is not omniscient. This is one of the most forceful logical proofs against the existence of God.

4 – Argument: By Occam's Razor [Jocax (?)]

- There is no evidence that God exists.
- The set {Universe + God} is more complex than simply {Universe}.
- By Occam's Razor, we should therefore discard the first hypothesis — a universe with God — in favor of the second, which is simpler, as it requires at minimum one fewer hypothesis.

Commentary: This reasoning can be illustrated by the "Nail Factory" metaphor. We should agree that if we had to choose between two hypotheses about the origin of everything, we should prefer the more probable one. Scientifically, we should lean toward physical theories about the universe's origin — for instance, the universe arising from a quantum vacuum fluctuation. That is only a theory, but far more reasonable than assuming the prior existence of an IMMENSE nail factory (God) that made all the nails, whose own origin no one dares question. You have evidence that "nails" (elementary particles) exist; someone says there must be a creator for these nails and proposes a vast, complex "Nail Factory" (God). But this is a nonsense: there is no evidence for the factory's existence, and it is VASTLY more complex than the nails themselves. By Occam's Razor, it is far more logical to suppose the nails always existed than that the immense "Nail Factory" always existed, hidden somewhere only accessible after death.

5 – Argument: God, If He Existed, Would Be an Automaton [André Sanchez & Jocax]

- God is omniscient, omnipotent, and knows everything that has happened and will happen.
- He knows including all of His own future actions.
- Therefore, He would have to follow all of His foreseen actions without being able to alter them — just as an automaton follows its programming.

Conclusion: God, if He existed, would have no free will. He would be a robot, a kind of automaton eternally following His prior programming (His own foresight) with no ability to change it. Commentary: God's omniscience would confine Him to a tedious prison from which nothing could escape, even if He wished it. He would be trapped by His own cruel omniscience.

6 – Proof: If God Existed, There Would Be No Imperfection [unknown author]

If God existed and were perfect, then everything He created would be perfect.

Man, being His creation, should also have been created perfect.

But how can a being created perfect become corrupted and imperfect?

If man became corrupted, then he was not perfect — he was corruptible!

Conclusion: God could not be perfect, as He produced something imperfect.

Commentary: A perfect being desires perfection, and even if He created man with free will — which we saw above is an illusion — if He were perfect, He would make perfect choices and not become corrupted.

7 – Argument: The Origin of God [unknown author]

The argument from Intelligent Design — according to which the complexity of Nature requires an intelligent creator — falls apart when no minimal explanation is offered for the origin of God Himself. Being something extremely complex and intelligent, God would, by the same argument, require an intelligent creator: the “God of God.” This “Creator of God,” being more intelligent than God, would — by the same reasoning — also require an extremely intelligent creator: the “God of the God of God.” And so on, ad infinitum, producing a nonsense in the argument that complexity requires an even more complex being to create it. Commentary: Intelligent Design is currently the most widely used argument — presented as if it were science — to teach religious courses in some Brazilian and North American states.

8 – Proof: The Universe Could Not Have Been Created [Jocax]

Suppose, for the sake of argument, that God exists. If God has infinite intelligence, He would not need to spend any time deciding something or processing information.

Therefore, He would spend no time deciding to create the universe. That is, the Universe would have had to be created at the very moment God Himself was created. If

God was never created, then the universe also could never have been created.
Commentary: If there is motion, there is time. If there was no time, nothing could move.

9 – Proof: God Cannot Be Perfect [unknown author]

If God were perfect, He would have no needs — He would be self-sufficient. However, if He decided to create the universe, He had a need for that creation and therefore was not self-sufficient — He was imperfect.

10 – Proof: God, If He Existed, Could Not Be Perfect [Jocax]

Many believers take the laws of Physics and their “magical” constants as evidence of divine wisdom, since even a small alteration in them would supposedly cause the universe to collapse. However, they forget that those very SAME laws — specifically the second law of thermodynamics — predict the inexorable, slow, and agonizing collapse of our universe, revealing a GRAVE FLAW in its conception that renders it unviable in the long run. Commentary: The second law of thermodynamics states that entropy in a closed system never decreases. We may consider the entire universe as a closed system, since nothing enters or exits it.

11 – Proof: God, If He Existed, Could Not Be Good [Jocax (?)]

A hypothetically omniscient and omnipotent God would have known everything that was going to happen BEFORE deciding to create the universe. He would have known who was going to be born and what each person would “choose” in their life. He would have known that an enormous TSUNAMI would appear and drown 40,000 children. If He had the power to make the universe slightly different, He could perhaps have prevented that tragedy. But, knowing EVERYTHING that would happen in the future — all the deaths, all the misfortunes and calamities — He put His plan into action and watched from a comfortable seat. That is not worthy of a benevolent being.

12 – Proof: By the Definition of Universe, God Could Not Have Created It [Jocax (?)]

According to the definition of Universe: the set of all things that exist or are believed to exist in time and space. Therefore, the Universe can be defined as the totality of everything that exists. As such, if God exists, He could not have created the Universe, since by definition He would already be part of it! Commentary: The believer could then only position God as the creator of matter/energy, not of the universe itself.

13 – Proof: By the Laws of Current Physics, God Could Not Exist [unknown author]

Quantum Mechanics has as its fundamental law the so-called “Uncertainty Principle.” According to this law, it is IMPOSSIBLE — regardless of technology — to know the exact position and speed of a particle simultaneously. This means that, physically, it is

impossible for an “Omniscient God” to exist, since such a being could know the exact position and speed of a particle, violating a fundamental pillar of modern science.

14 – Proof: God, If He Existed, Would Be Sadistic and Selfish [Renato W. Lima (?)]

It can be shown that God would need to create an imperfect world; otherwise the world would be Himself. One might argue that creating a clone of Himself would be better than creating an imperfect world only to sadistically watch it suffer. Yet knowing the world is not perfect does not imply one should deny it assistance when needed — provided, of course, there is power to help and one does not desire evil (i.e., one is good). If God truly created beings as imperfect and different from Himself as we are, He is being selfish, desiring to remain the sole perfect and powerful being. And selfishness is definitively not something good.

15 – Argument: Igor’s Theorem [Igor Silva (?)]

If we had to choose one of the two options below, which would be more probable or easier to occur?

A – A dead person resurecting and ascending to heaven (without rockets), or

B – Someone writing lies on a piece of paper or in a book and people believing them?

A – Someone performing miracles that defied the laws of Physics, or

B – Someone writing lies on a piece of paper or in a book and people believing them?

A – An all-powerful being (God) existing and creating the universe, or

B – Someone writing lies on a piece of paper or in a book and people believing them?

Commentary: This text is a simplification of Hume’s argument: “[...] *no testimony is sufficient to establish a miracle, unless the testimony be of such a kind, that its falsehood would be more miraculous than the fact which it endeavours to establish.*” David Hume, “Of Miracles” (1748).

16 – Argument: By the Kalam Theorem [Unknown]

The Kalam theorem asserts that nothing can extend infinitely into the past, because if there were an infinite time in the past, it would take an infinite time from that past to our present. But an infinite time means never. Therefore we would never reach the present. But that is absurd, since we are in the present. Likewise, if a God’s existence extended infinitely into the past, we could not have the present either. Therefore, a God who has existed for an infinite past time cannot exist.

17 – Argument: By the Non-Necessity of Cause [Jocax]

The origin of the universe and its laws can be satisfactorily explained through the Jocaxian Nothingness (JN). The JN logically explains how the cosmos could arise from Jocaxian Nothingness, since that Nothingness would possess no laws restricting

anything whatsoever. Thus, due to the absence of laws, events could occur. This eliminates the need for a conscious creator such as God to explain our cosmos.